Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	27 October 2026
Team ID	SWUID2026403463
Project Name	HotelPro – Hotel Management System (Room Booking, Guest Management & Payments)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

Persona 1 – Guest (Hotel Customer / Traveller)

GOAL

Find a suitable room for my dates quickly, see real photos and prices, pay securely and get my booking confirmed without any hassle.

What do they HEAR?

- Friends and online reviews say which hotels are clean and worth the price
- Good rooms sell out fast during weekends and holidays
- Offers and discounts announced through banners and emails
- Reminders about check-in time and pending payments before the stay
- Front-desk staff ask for the booking ID and ID proof at arrival

What do they THINK and FEEL?

PAINS

- A room shown as available is already taken at payment; fear of double booking
- Hidden charges and taxes appearing at the last step
- Payment failures and unclear refund status after a cancellation
- Slow pages and long forms during peak booking periods
- Photos that do not match the real room; losing booking details

GAINS

- Live availability for the chosen dates with clear room photos and amenities
- Transparent total price (nights × nightly rate) shown before booking
- Simple payment with a clear status: pending, paid or refunded
- Easy cancellation with the refund status shown up front
- One place for all bookings, history and payment status

What do they need to DO?

- Search rooms by check-in date, check-out date and room type
- Compare room photos, amenities, capacity and price per night
- Choose a room, select the number of guests and reserve it
- Pay on the payment page by card, UPI or pay at the hotel
- View My Bookings and cancel if plans change

What do they DO?

- Browses rooms and studies the photos and descriptions
- Compares prices, room types and amenities before deciding
- Checks availability for exact dates and number of guests
- Pays online and checks My Bookings for confirmation
- Arrives, checks in at the front desk and checks out at the end of the stay

What do they SAY?

- "I want to see the real room before I book."
- "Don't let someone else get the room while I'm paying."
- "Show me the full price up front, no surprises."
- "I need my money back if I have to cancel."

Persona 2 – Hotel Manager / Front-Desk Staff / Admin

Understand the needs of the people who run the hotel and manage the platform behind the scenes.

GOAL

Run the hotel smoothly: keep rooms filled, avoid double booking, check guests in and out quickly and track bookings, payments and revenue.

What do they HEAR?

- Guests complain when a booked room is not ready or refunds are slow
- Owners ask for daily and monthly occupancy and revenue reports
- Front-desk staff report long queues at check-in
- Guests ask to change or cancel bookings at short notice

What do they THINK and FEEL?

PAINS

- Double booking or overbooking of rooms
- Manual registers and scattered spreadsheets
- Cancellations and refunds handled by hand
- No clear record of who changed room prices or data
- Risk of unauthorised access to staff and admin tools

GAINS

- Real-time view of booked, checked-in and available rooms
- Automatic overlap check that blocks double booking
- Payment and refund status tracked on every booking
- Dashboard with active bookings, guests in-house and revenue
- Role-based access (guest, staff, admin) behind a secure login

What do they need to DO?

- Add, edit and remove rooms with prices, amenities and photos
- Check guests in and out from the bookings list
- Review all bookings with guest details and payment status
- Monitor active bookings, arrivals and revenue
- Cancel bookings and control access by role (staff or admin)

What do they DO?

- Manages the room inventory, prices and photos
- Checks in arriving guests and checks out departing ones
- Reviews bookings, payments and refunds with filters and search
- Monitors the dashboard for today's arrivals and revenue
- Handles cancellations and guest requests

What do they SAY?

- "I need to see which rooms are free right now."
- "Block overlapping bookings automatically."
- "Check-in should take seconds, not minutes."
- "Show me today's arrivals and total revenue."